CHAPTER 07 / NUTRITION

Your muscle-building diet

Real food. Real life. Your budget.

Build practical meals with familiar Indian foods.

How to use this guide

Read the explanations, try the practical examples and complete the worksheet. All training logs and menus are illustrative. Use the website for interactive tools; this document remains useful offline.

01	02	03
Understand	Put into practice	Review

Scope and safety

General education for adults, not a medical diagnosis, personalized treatment or a guaranteed transformation. Stop exercise for sharp pain or unusual symptoms. A qualified clinician, dietitian or coach can help when individual circumstances require assessment.

What you will learn

01. Build around protein
02. Make the meal practical
03. Raw and cooked are different
04. Before, after and between sessions
05. Adjust for your goal

01 / Build around protein

For most healthy exercising adults, an overall daily protein intake around 1.4–2.0 g/kg is supported by the ISSN position stand. Needs depend on context. Spread protein across convenient meals rather than saving all of it for one sitting. More protein does not replace a useful training stimulus.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE: At 70 kg, 1.6 g/kg is an illustrative 112 g/day target, not a universal prescription.

02 / Make the meal practical

Combine a protein food, a carbohydrate source, vegetables or fruit and some dietary fat. Eggs, chicken, fish, milk and curd are options; soy, dal, chickpeas and paneer offer vegetarian choices. Nuts add energy and nutrients but are not always the cheapest way to reach a protein target.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE: Batch-cook dal and rice, then vary vegetables and the protein side.

03 / Raw and cooked are different

Cooking changes water content and therefore the nutrients per 100 g. One hundred grams of dry rice is not nutritionally equivalent to 100 g of cooked rice. Weigh the food in the state listed in the planner. Brand, cut, recipe and added oil change the result.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE: Use a package label when available, and count cooking oil separately.

04 / Before, after and between sessions

A familiar meal with carbohydrate and protein before training may be comfortable if you allow time to digest. Afterward, return to a normal meal pattern. Carry water, and adjust for heat and sweat. Avoid introducing unfamiliar foods immediately before a demanding session.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE: A banana and curd may be convenient; tolerance and the rest of your day still matter.

05 / Adjust for your goal

Weight gain needs enough overall food, not unlimited junk food. Maintenance aims for a stable trend. Fat loss should preserve training, adequate nourishment and a sustainable pace. The templates below are editable starting menus, not complete individualized diets or guaranteed daily nutrient coverage.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE: Prices are illustrative planning assumptions in rupees, not live shop quotes.

Practical reference

Food composition estimates

Approximate values per 100 g of edible food in the stated condition. Generic estimates vary by brand, recipe and preparation. Price assumptions in the website are editable examples, not live market prices.

Food / condition	kcal	Protein g	Carbs g	Fat g
Rice / cooked	130	2.7	28	0.3
Milk / as sold, whole	61	3.2	4.8	3.3
Curd / plain, whole	61	3.5	4.7	3.3
Egg / boiled, edible portion	155	12.6	1.1	10.6
Chicken breast / cooked, skinless	165	31	0	3.6
Fish / cooked, generic lean fish	128	26	0	2.7
Oats / dry	389	16.9	66.3	6.9
Banana / raw, peeled	89	1.1	22.8	0.3
Peanuts / raw, shelled	567	25.8	16.1	49.2
Almonds / raw	579	21.2	21.6	49.9
Soy chunks / dry, generic label estimate	345	52	33	0.5
Paneer / as sold, generic full-fat estimate	265	18.3	1.2	20.8
Dal / lentils / cooked, plain without oil	116	9	20.1	0.4
Chickpeas / cooked, drained	164	8.9	27.4	2.6
Mixed vegetables / cooked without oil, estimate	65	2.5	13	0.5
Cooking oil / as sold	884	0	0	100

Calculation example

For a hypothetical 25-year-old male weighing 70 kg at 175 cm: resting expenditure = 10 × 70 + 6.25 × 175 − 5 × 25 + 5 = 1,673.75 kcal/day. At an assumed activity multiplier of 1.55, TDEE is approximately 2,594 kcal/day. This is an estimate, not a measurement.

The website uses example goal adjustments of +8% for gradual gain or −10% for gradual loss. Protein is allocated at 1.6 g/kg, fat at 30% of target energy, and carbohydrate receives the remainder. These defaults are teaching assumptions, not individual prescriptions.

A practical student meal

An example plate can combine cooked rice, plain cooked dal, curd and vegetables. Add a protein side that fits preferences and needs. Record the amount and whether it is raw or cooked. Include added oil. A single plate does not establish a complete day of nutrition.

Your study worksheet

Knowledge check

Why must a food entry say raw or cooked?

A. Only for appearance

B. Water changes weight and nutrient concentration

C. It does not matter

Reflect and apply

Prompt	Your response
One idea I can explain in my own words	
One action I can try this week	
What I will observe or measure	
What would make me seek professional guidance	
My next review date	

Chapter summary

Use affordable familiar foods, match weight states and adapt the menu to your actual needs.

Answer and explanation

B. Cooking changes the amount of water per gram; use the matching entry.

Sources & limitations

These sources inform the educational principles. Original examples and planning templates are not study findings. No institution listed below endorses this journal. References checked November 2026.

ISSN (2017) — Protein and exercise position stand

https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5477153/

USDA — FoodData Central: food composition reference

https://fdc.nal.usda.gov/

ICMR–NIN — National Institute of Nutrition

https://www.nin.res.in/

Interpretation matters

Research describes groups under particular conditions. Individual responses vary. The website models are simplified illustrations, not precise physiological simulations. Food values and calorie estimates are approximate. Use consistent observation and individualized professional support when needed.